

E-COMMERCE CONSUMER PROTECTION STANDARDS, 2026

(ILLUSTRATIVE)

Sample document generated for RAG test-dataset purposes — not an official publication

1. Applicability

1.1 These Standards apply to any e-commerce entity with more than 10,000 registered users or annual sales above Rs. 1 crore within the State.

2. Return and Refund Rights

2.1 A consumer may return a product within 7 days of delivery without providing a reason, except for perishable goods and personalised items. 2.2 A refund initiated by the consumer must be processed within 5 working days of the returned item being received by the seller.

3. Disclosure Obligations

3.1 An e-commerce entity must display the country of origin, total price inclusive of all charges, and seller identity for every listed product. 3.2 Any price increase triggered by a promotional countdown timer must reflect an actual, verifiable price change and not a simulated scarcity indicator.

4. Grievance Redressal

4.1 An e-commerce entity must appoint a Grievance Officer who acknowledges a complaint within 48 hours and resolves it within 30 days. 4.2 A consumer dissatisfied with the resolution may approach the Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission within 2 years of the cause of action.

5. Dark Pattern Prohibition

5.1 An e-commerce entity shall not use interface designs that make cancellation of a subscription more difficult than sign-up, including hiding the cancellation option beyond 2 navigation steps from the account page. 5.2 Pre-ticked consent boxes for paid add-ons are prohibited at checkout.

6. Penalties

6.1 Violation of Section 5 shall attract a fine of up to Rs. 10,00,000 for the first instance and up to Rs. 50,00,000 for repeat violations. 6.2 Failure to meet the refund timeline under Section 2.2 shall entitle the consumer to a further 2% of the refund amount per week of delay, payable by the seller.